



Don't Digitize Yesterday, Design for Tomorrow

ABMS Member Board Connect
September 15, 2026

Objectives



Describe the phased approach ABP took from exploration through decision



Identify key activities that supported us at each phase of this journey



Outline what comes next



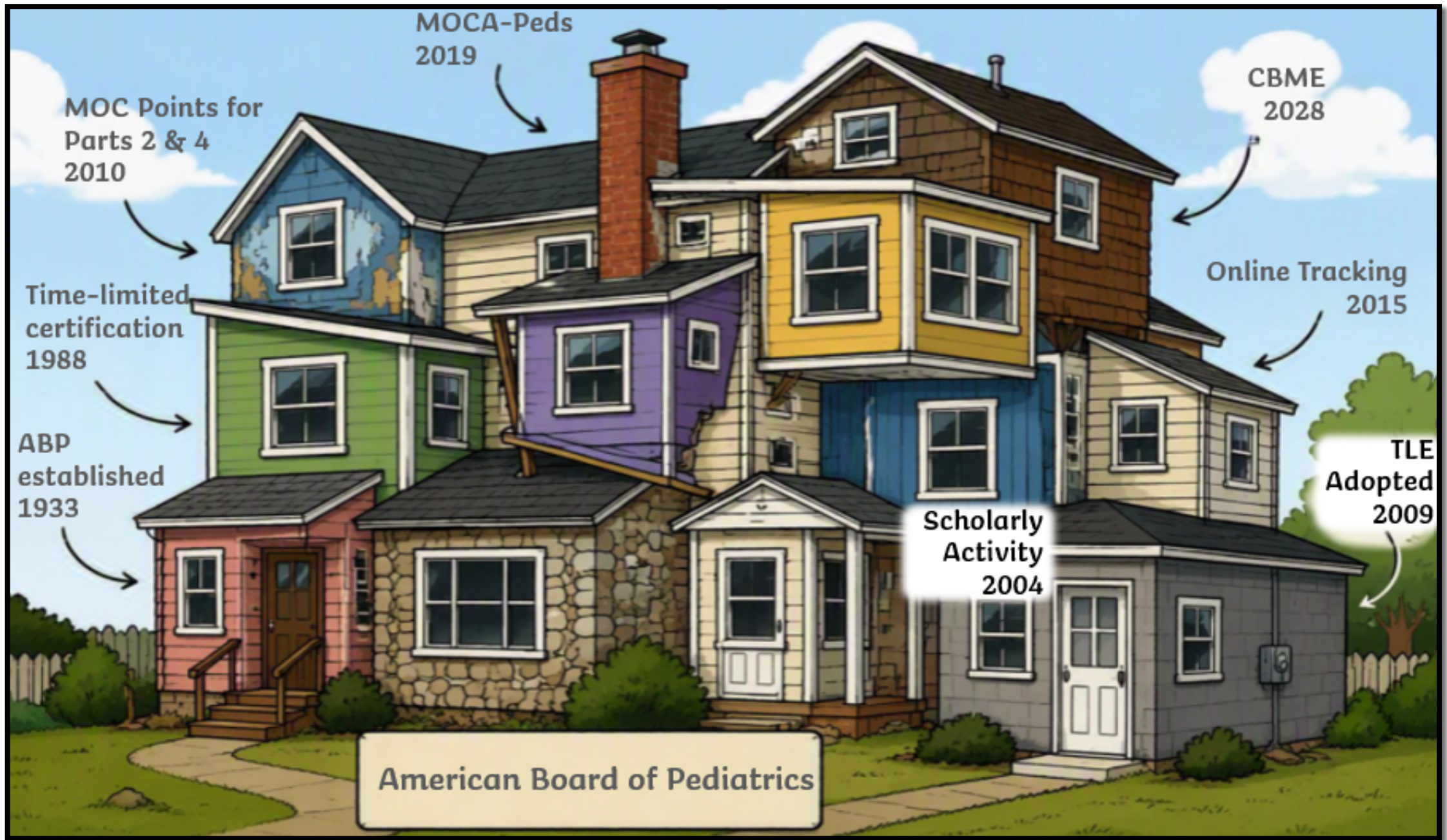
Explain how change management was embedded throughout our journey

Quick Show of Hands

Where are you on your journey?

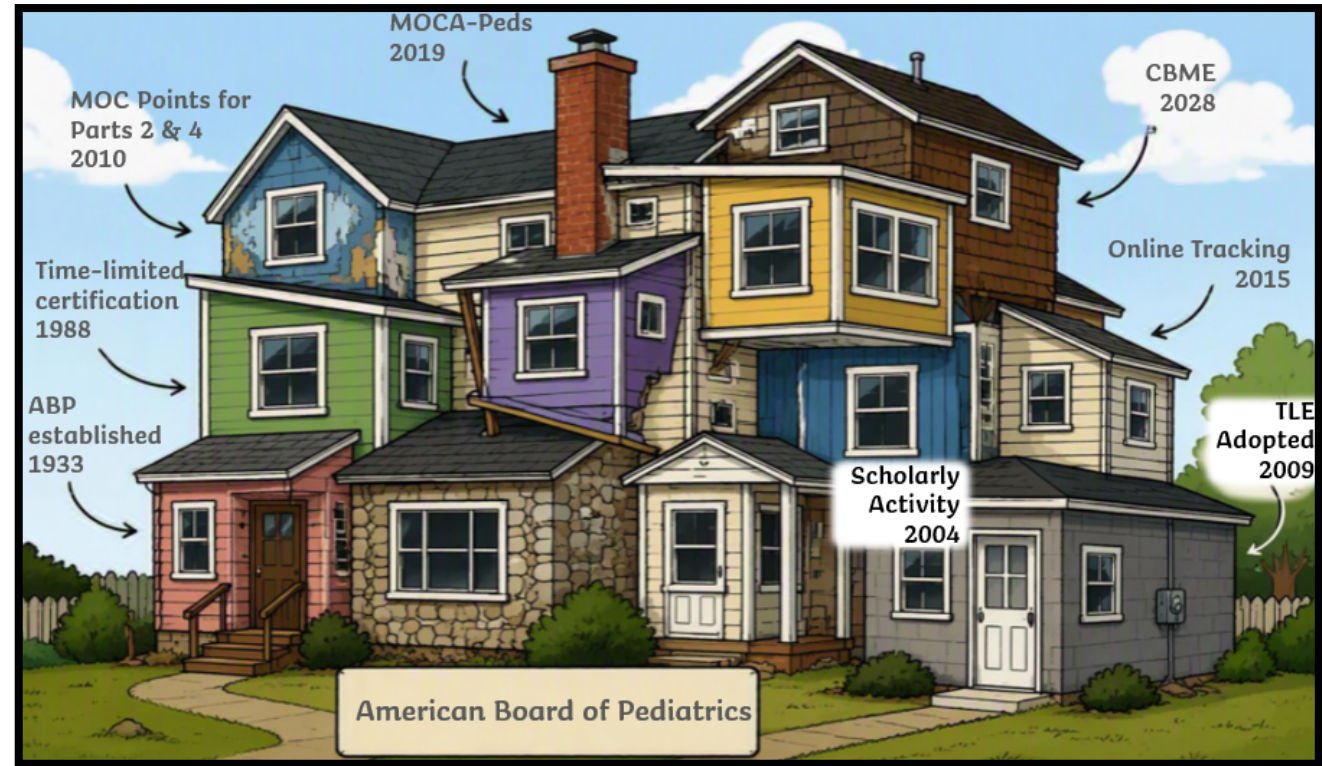
- Still living with a legacy system
- Exploring technology options
- Building or migrating to a new system
- Already implemented a new system





Why We Started This Journey

- Manual work and fragmented workflows limited efficiency
- Decades of layered rules and workarounds added complexity
- Our legacy system had become increasingly difficult to evolve
- We needed greater flexibility to support future strategic goals.



Question For The Audience

Channeling your best inner skeptic,
what are some reasons why going
from a bespoke system to an off-the-
shelf product is a *bad idea*?

Ask the Right Question

Is there a product we can buy that can handle the complexity of our work?



Our work is so unique – there's no way a standard product can handle it.



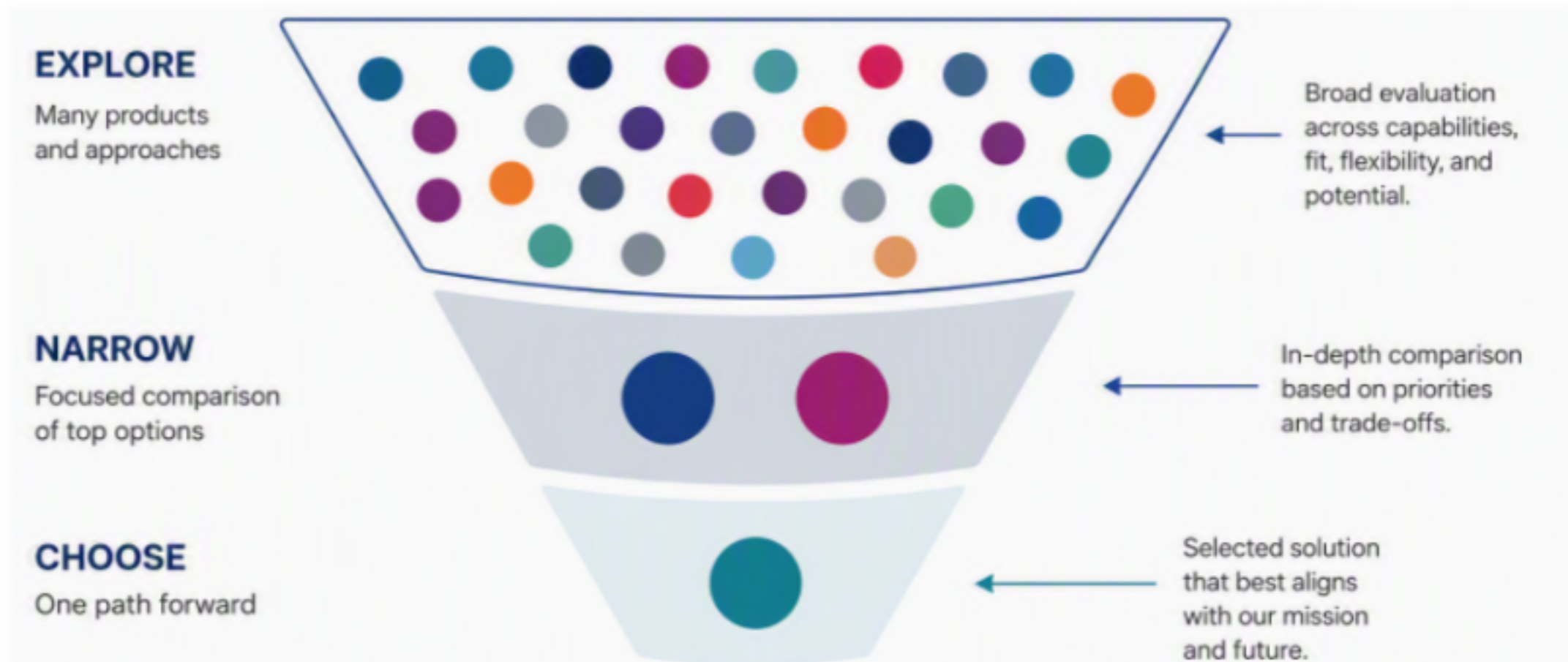
We have special processes, complex workflows, and a lot of custom needs.



Other organizations might be able to use a commercial-off-the-shelf product, we are different.

Exploration & POC Phase

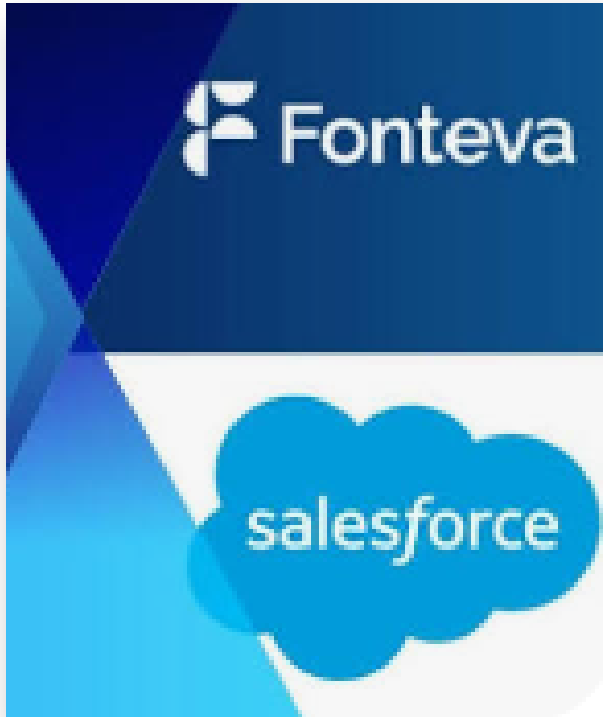
December 2024 – April 2025



Ask the Right Question

Question

Is there a product we can buy that can handle the complexity of our work?



Answer:

Turns out that we might not be as unique as we thought. We found a solution that was worth investigating.

Ask the Right Question

Do we want to modernize our technology or dedicate the time to reimagine our business?

Shiny new system, with yesterday inside:

- Old approvals become digital approvals
- Old workarounds become configured workflows
- Old silos become cleaner-looking silos



Modernization changes the **tool. Transformation changes the **work**.**

Pre-Discovery Phase

May 2025 – September
2025



Business Transformation

- 5 Lean-based Workshops
- Engaging 50+ ABP Staff Members

Business Transformation Workshops

Workshop Structure

Each workshop spanned **3 days** and focused on a key ABP process area:

1. Trainee Tracking and Program Management
2. Credentialing, Disciplinary Action, & Test Accommodations
3. Test Development & Psychometrics
4. Continuing Certification Activities
5. Continuing Certification Rules

Daily Workshop Focus

Day 1: *Understand Current State & Identify Challenges*

Map the current state, surface pain points, identify assumptions, and gather stakeholder insights.

Day 2: *Idea Generation & Future State Design*

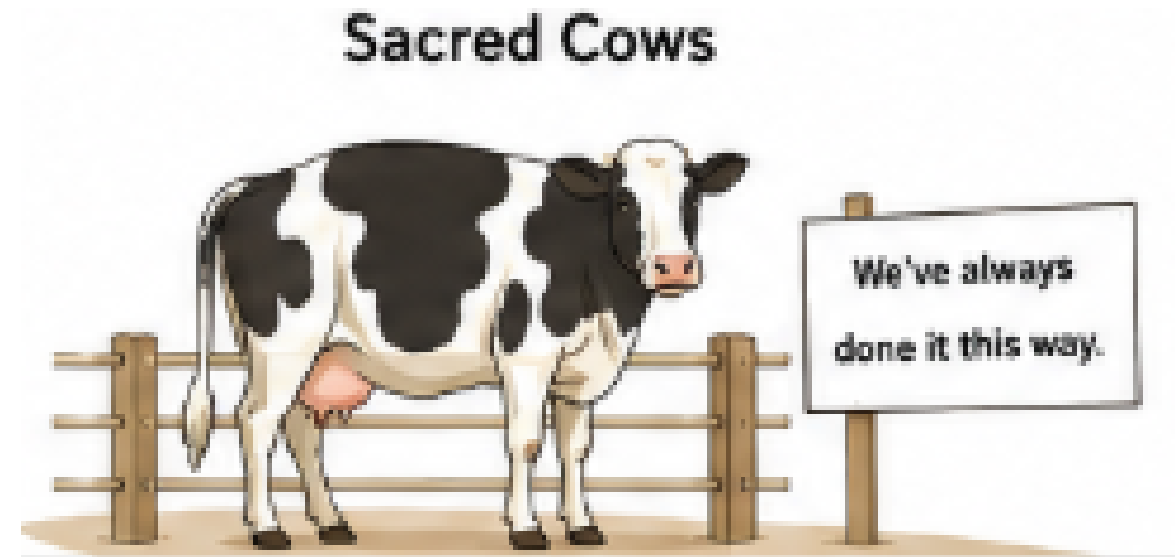
Brainstorm solutions and design improved, future-ready processes.

Day 3: *Finalize Future State & Document Deliverables*

Align on new process designs, confirm decisions, and capture actionable outputs.

Challenging Assumptions

- ABMS member boards operate with a lot of flexibility to meet the needs of our diplomates.
- There are ABMS Initial Certification Standards, Continuing Certification Standards, and Testing Standards we all have to meet.



Most other rules and policies are decisions we've made and can be revisited.

Table Challenge (5 minutes)

Choose one process, rule, or policy your organization assumes must stay the same.



NAME IT

What have you always thought didn't make sense, but feels untouchable?



PROVE IT

What is the regulation, standard, or authority that requires it?



REIMAGINE

If you ~~it~~ were redesigning it for 2035, what would be different?



TACKLE IT

What is a next step you could take to challenge this sacred cow?

Ask the Right Question

Can our new vision become a buildable plan?



> **Discovery
Phase**

Discovery Phase

December 2025 – July 2026



Learning Sessions

15 Business Sessions
11 Integration Sessions



Documentation

7 Detailed Requirement Documents



Scoping Phase I

Finalized Included Features, Systems & Requirements



Project Plan

Mapping Dependencies, Demos, Timelines

Ask the Right Question

Question

Can our shiny new vision become a buildable plan?



Answer:

After months of work with our implementation partner, the team decided it was possible!

Ask the Right Question

Is it feasible to move forward with a new system?



Ask the Right Question

Question

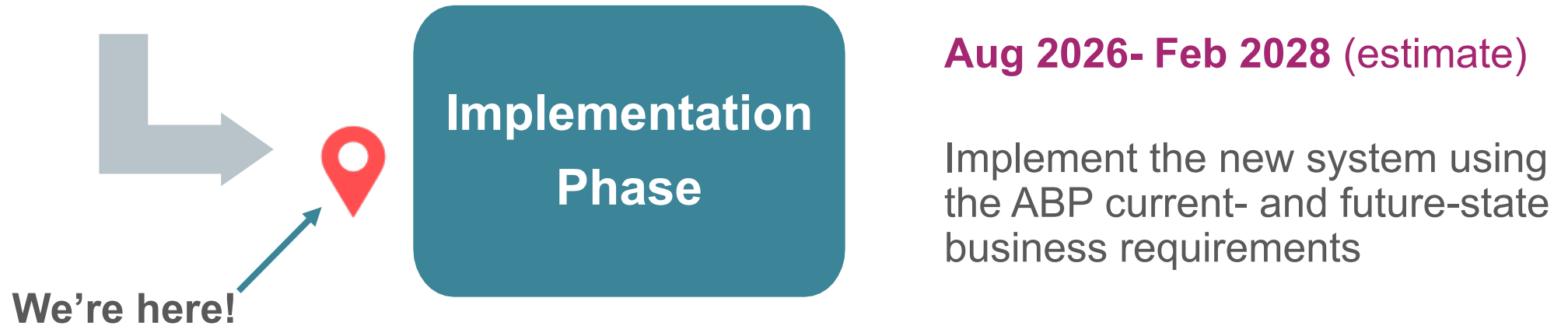
Is it feasible to move forward with a new system?



Answer:

Yes, we received approval in August to move forward with implementation!

What Comes Next?



**Estimated Go-live Date: February 1,
2028**

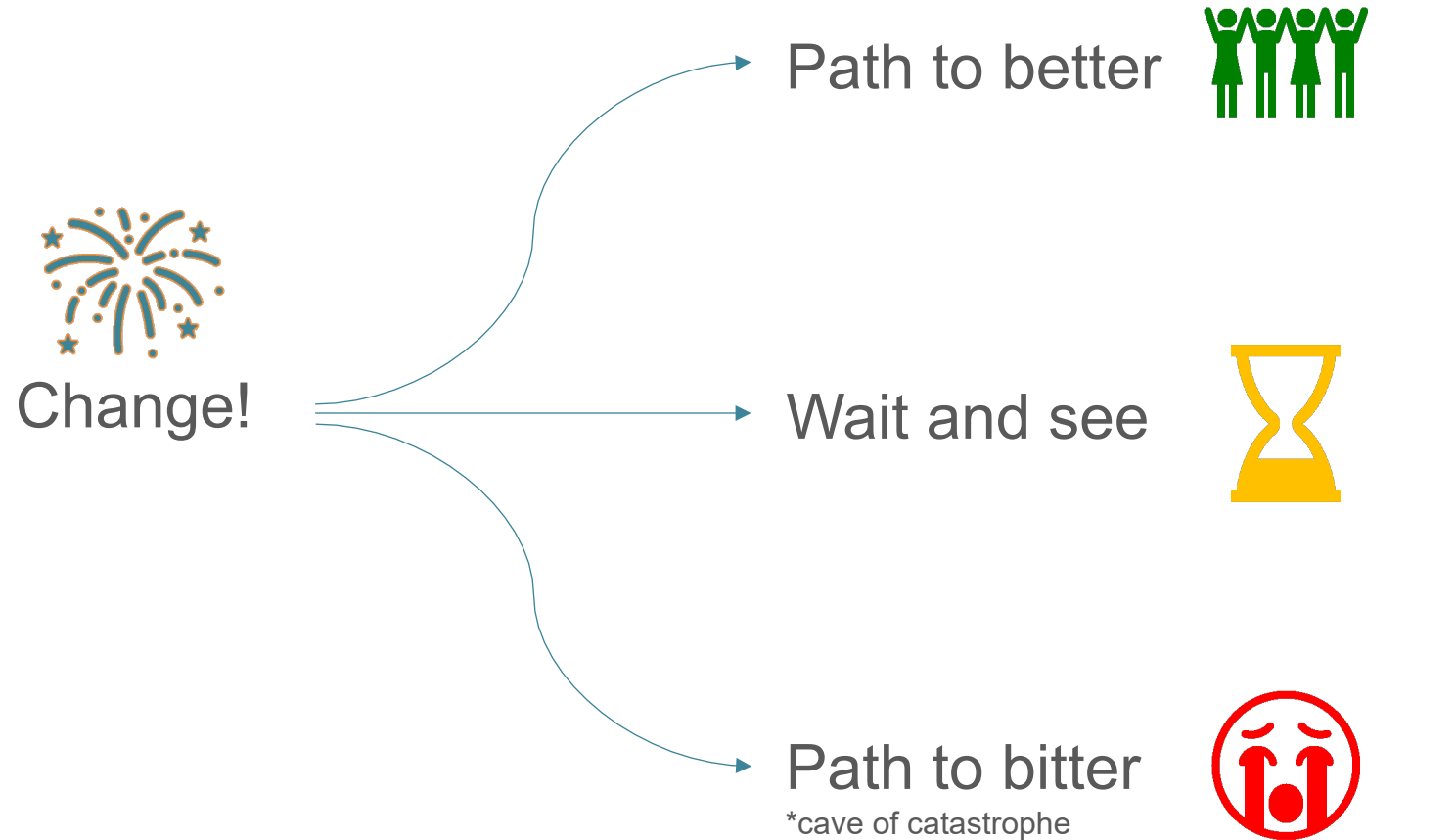
Ask the Right Question

Question:

Is our staff ready for this change?

1. Provide a framework for evaluation
2. Tell stories; use metaphors
3. Answer the why (again and again)
4. Share what you know

1-Provide a Framework



In the beginning, it's totally normal to be anywhere along this continuum...

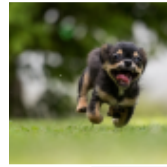
But, ultimately, we want everyone climbing the path to better.

1-Be Real About Where You Are



Reserved

- Groundhog Day
- “I’ll save these sticky notes so they can be used next time we do this exercise.”
- “I’ll believe it when I see it.”
- Feelings: cynicism,



Excited

- Yay!
- “Always love new tech!”
- “But what does it mean for me?”
- Feelings: excitement, curiosity



Fence sitters

- Verdict out
- “It could go either way, so I won’t invest too much in it now.”
- “I’ll wait to see if SLT comes together.”
- Feeling: ambivalence

Other real, legitimate feelings:

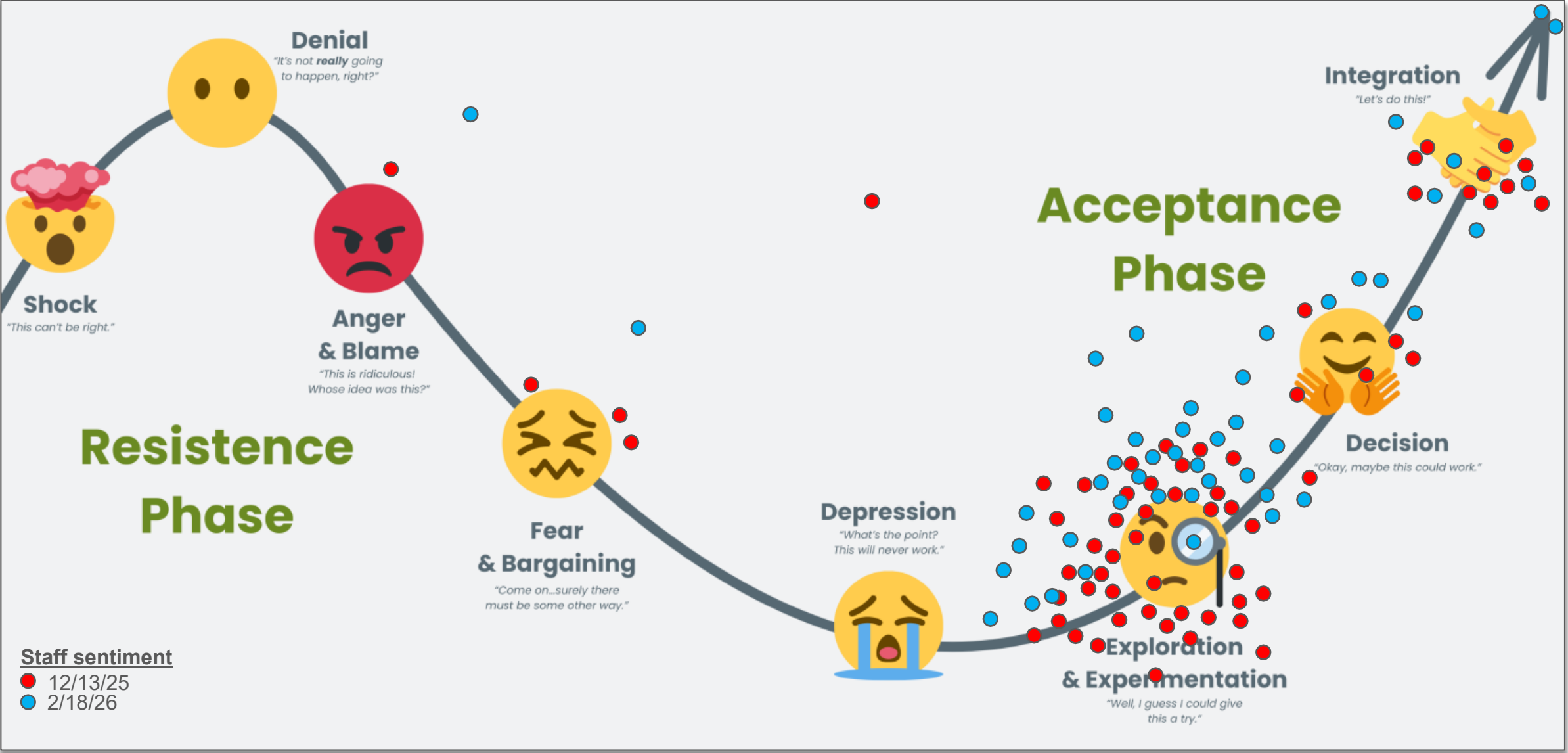
Fear. Some fear that their jobs are at risk.

Accusatory. Some point fingers; the effort will be “sabotaged.”

Loss. Some grieve investment in legacy systems and processes.

Hopeful. Some see opportunity to fill unmet needs.

1-Measure Over Time



2-Tell Stories

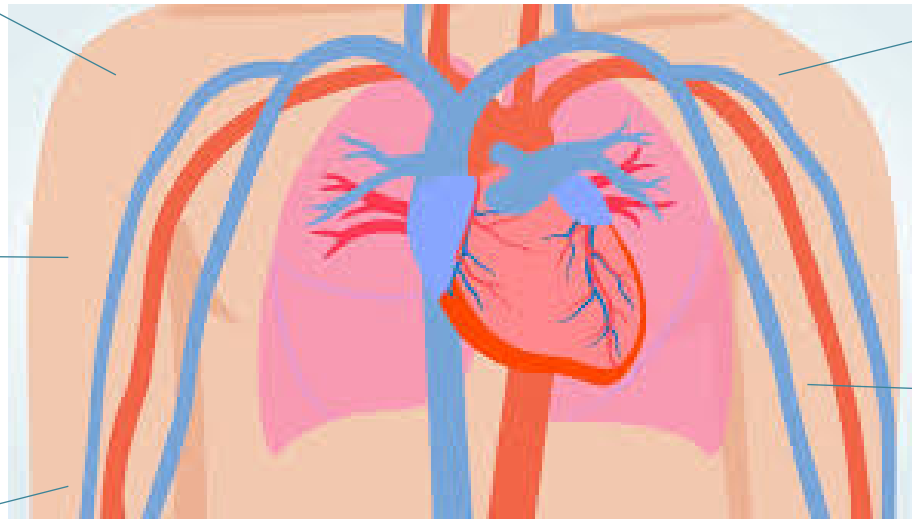


2-Use Metaphors

Changes to sub-specialty certification paths/processes

Changes to MOC rules and requirements

Enhanced ABP financial reporting



Advance organizational goals re: CBME

Streamlined and improved trainee and diplomate communications

**BTI is the heart of
how we'll operate in
the future**

3-Answer the Why

Why We Are Implementing the Business Transformation Initiative

We're launching this initiative to position our organization for **long-term success and future growth.**

This transformation will streamline our workflow, reduce the effort required to maintain our processes, and minimize manual workarounds that slow us down today. The goal is to ensure we can evolve alongside technology and seize new opportunities. It will help us **focus on the capabilities that truly set us apart** while relying on trusted partners for the functions that don't need to be built or maintained in-house.

By strengthening our operations, we create the capacity to **be more innovative, more strategic, and more responsive to both operational and ABP constituent needs.** This initiative aims to equip our staff and organization with the tools and structure necessary to grow, adapt, and deliver our best work, creating a lasting impact for years to come.

What This Initiative Is Not

This is not a cost-cutting effort, and it is not about reducing staff. Our goal is to **support our people with better tools, clearer processes, and a more sustainable operating environment.**

3-Answer the Why in a Different Way



Our business transformation is a significant change, but it is necessary to fulfill our mission—for the ABP, for our diplomates, and for the children they serve.

3-Answer the Why Again...



Taylor the Trainee

Navigating exam application and certification for the first time. Seeking a seamless user experience

With BTI: Plain language, guided self-service...***and one portal they'll use for the rest of their career!***



Pete the Program Director

Tracking trainees using multiple systems and manual workarounds

With BTI: More automation, user-friendly dashboards, and ***streamlined reporting of EPAs!***

3-And Again...

1

Support our long-term success and future growth.

2

Focus on the capabilities that truly set us apart.

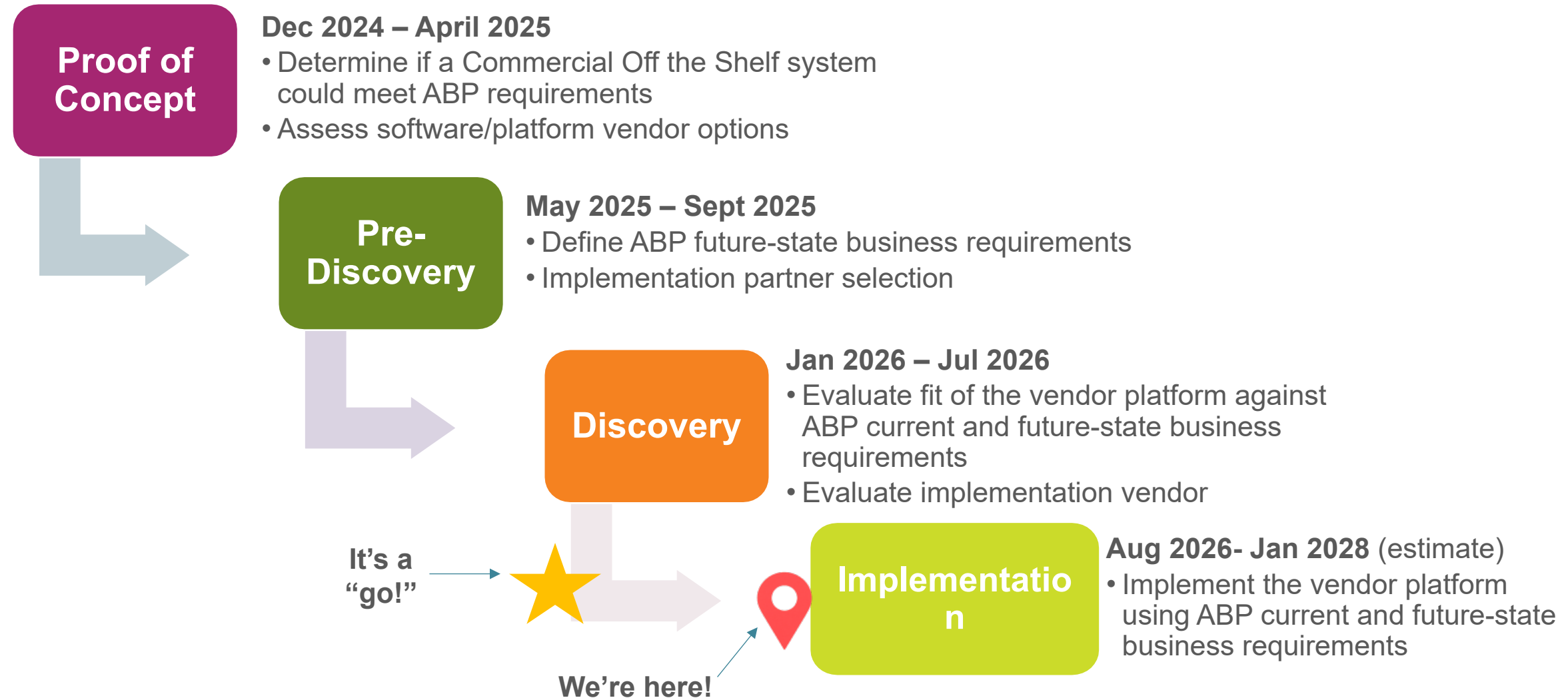
3

Be more innovative, more strategic, and more responsive to both operational and ABP constituent needs.

4

Support our people with better tools, clearer processes, and a more sustainable operating environment.

4-Share What You Know (the map)



4-Share What You Know (the what)

THE PLATFORM — SYSTEMS WE RUN ON

THE FOUNDATION

Salesforce — our core platform

The shared CRM and single source of data for the whole organization. Everything below runs on it.

↓ Both of these run on Salesforce

WHERE THE DAILY WORK HAPPENS

Fonteva — our CMS

The Certification Management System for day-to-day work: diplomate & candidate records, certification, MOC, exams, events, and dues.

Built natively on Salesforce.

HOW WE REACH PEOPLE

Marketing Cloud

Email and outbound communications to diplomates and candidates.

A Salesforce product; shares the same data.

OUR PARTNERS — ONE TEAM

BUILDS IT

fusionSpan

Implementation vendor — configures and builds the system, handles integrations, and trains staff.

KEEPS US ON TRACK

Creo

Project management oversight — schedule, governance, and sponsor support.

Contact: Michelle Baker

OWNS AND USES IT

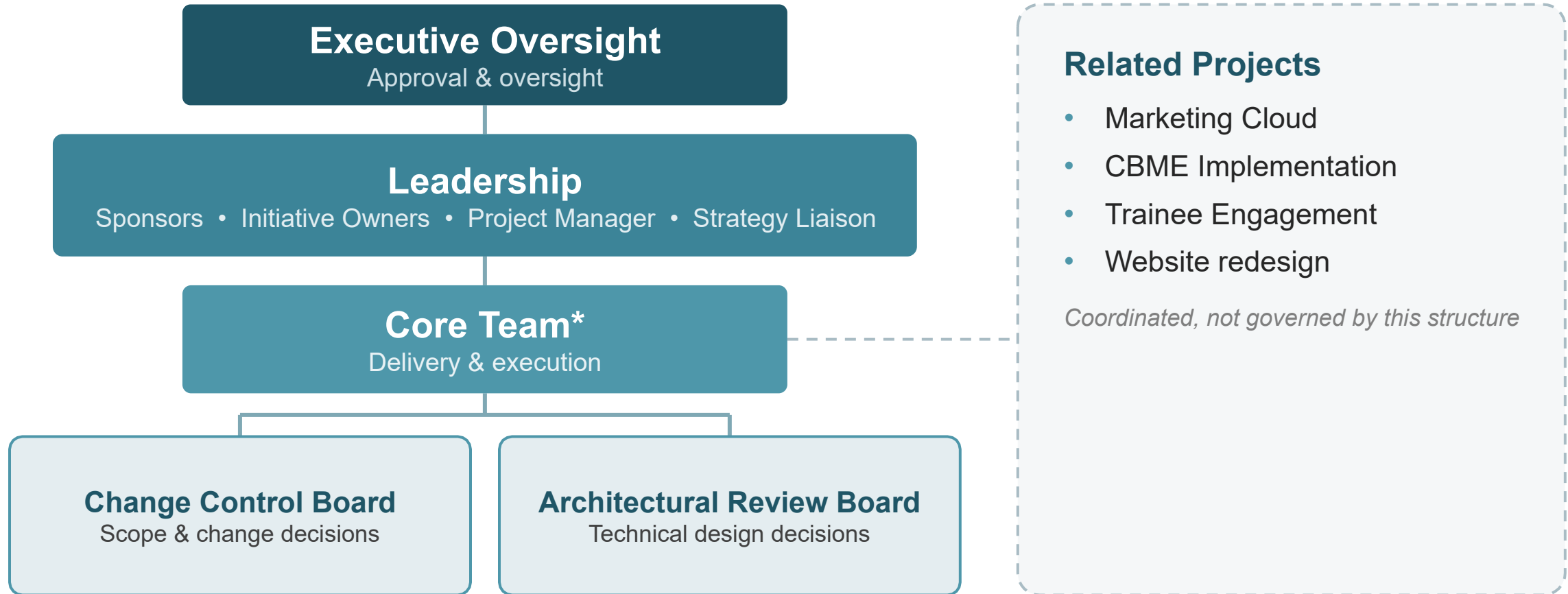
ABP — that's us

Coordinates internal readiness across departments.

Contact: Robert Frederick

4-Share What You Know (the who)

BTI Implementation | Organizing for Success

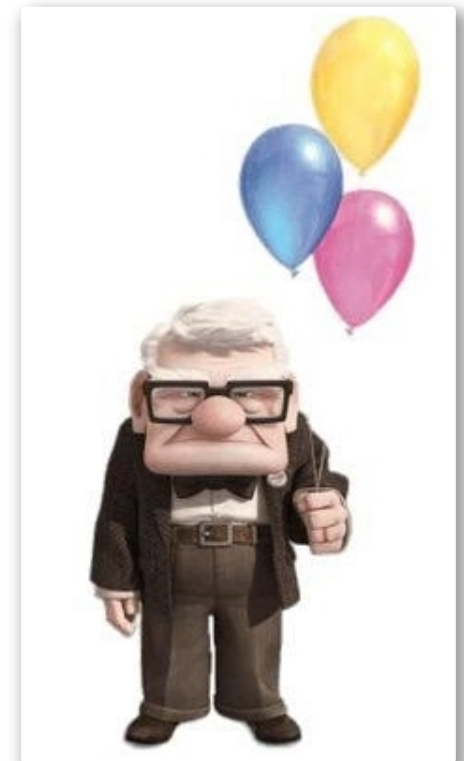
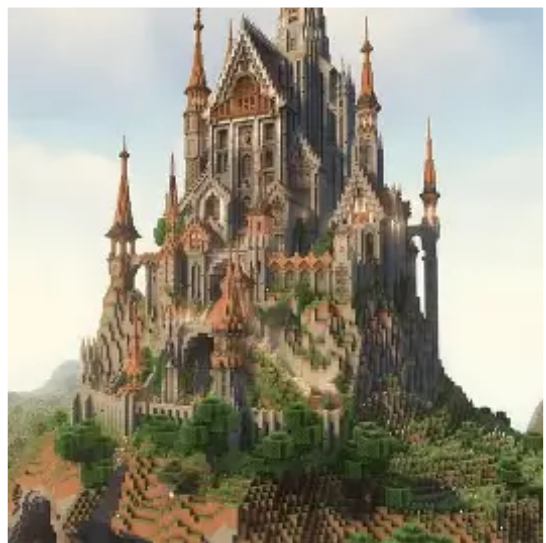


*Should include all workstream leads on next slide



**Consider a change you are
managing...**

**What visuals could you use
to present the “why”?**



What We've Learned So Far

WENT WELL

- Separate feasibility from future-state design
- Use cross-functional, facilitated workshops
- Make decisions and assumptions visible
- Treat readiness as an outcome
- Keep the future horizon in view

COULD IMPROVE

- Clarify governance even earlier
- Protect staff capacity for transformation work
- Clarify expectations with vendors
- Collaboration and inclusion of all partners
- Track decisions and dependencies relentlessly



Questions?
